

and ideas. Among those removed from all mortal realms are the Dark-kin, commonly referred to as Denizens. As a result of the conflict between the Fomorians and the Tuatha de Danaan, these Denizens were barred from the waking world. The Tuatha enacted the Silver Ban and forbade them from walking the Silver Path. As pockets of dark Glamour began to leak back into the Autumn World, however, they provided ways for the Denizens to once again walk among mortals.

Direct descendants of the Fomorians and the Tuatha de Danaan, these beings are nigh immortal; while they do not truly live forever, they can have lifespans that stretch for hundreds of years before reincarnating into a new form. Though these creatures may appear humanoid, they have very little in common with mortals or even changelings. Their minds and motivations are inscrutable even to those touched by fae heritage. Though they are born of mortal concepts, they know very little about the mortal realms. To some, the Autumn world is a source of endless mystery, while others care very little for the Banal world outside the Dreaming.

Due to their unique heritage, Denizens are not bound by the same rules as other fae. They have no such ruling forces as seemings and courts and care little for the way they divide the personalities of such lesser beings in the mortal realm. Much as changelings have kiths, Denizens also belong to general families known as adhene, which dictate their powers and proclivities.

Instead of seemings and courts determining the actions and attitude of a Denizen, she follows instead a three-way division of influence. These metaphysical divisions, called Ariá, make up the layers of a Denizen's personality, and function in a tiered system. The primary Ariá is most often in control and has the strongest influence on a Dark-kin, and the secondary and tertiary Ariá have progressively less hold on her personality. Much like seemings, the dominant Ariá can change as a Denizen encounters new situations. However, while changelings have no "default" seeming, a Denizen always has an Ariá she favors over the others. Even if something occurs to shift which Ariá is currently ruling, in time, her favored Ariá always reasserts itself.

Without regard for the Seelie and Unseelie Courts, the concepts of good and evil are not lost on Denizens, but they can be a good deal muddier. Many changelings would write them off as simply Unseelie as a whole and be done with it, but such classification denies a large fraction with more traditionally Seelie tendencies. A great many Denizens have no issue blending the ideals of the Courts; aonides may do awful, "Unseelie" things in the pursuit of a wholly consuming love; fir-bholg are usually seen as wise and honor-bound beings, traits that are typically associated with the Seelie Court, and yet they regain Glamour through the sacrifice of others, without question or care. While they do not adhere to one Court or another, nothing stops a Denizen from allying herself with members of either Court. Though many Dark-kin do have at least some Unseelie tendencies or associations, they have little love or trust for the Shadow Court and its members.

Many adhene of the Denizens have a land or culture where they are believed to have originated, areas where the minds of humans were especially focused on the ideas that make them

unique. The acheri are widely accepted as Indian lore. Fir-bholg are considered native to Ireland, while the moiræ are most famous as the Greco-Roman Oracles. This does not mean they exist or existed only in these places in the Autumn world, merely that the dreams and ideas that shaped them were focused originally in those cultures. They may be most populous in those areas, but Denizens can and do exist outside of their home cultures. They are less attracted to customs and location as they are to specific Dreamers, and have little regard for geographical borders or nationalities. Due to this propensity to gravitate toward individuals instead of pockets of society, many adhene have been given multiple names by varying human cultures. The Denizens that make up their adhene accept these local terms, but amongst other fae or changelings are referred to by their marginally more neutral names.

Rumors abound concerning the persistence of Denizens after the Sundering. With so many locked away in the Dreaming and out of contact with the mortals, would they not fade away into legend? The answer to this that many have found is a breed of Denizen known as the Evanescent. These Denizens either went into hiding outside the Dreaming or were locked out as trods and pathways slammed shut. During the last great conflict between the Fomorian and Tuatha de Danaan, eruptions of dark Glamour brought some Denizens through again. Among these Evanescent were aonides, keremet, and moiræ.

Belief and Governance

Despite their disregard for humanity itself, the minds of the Dark-kin work in very similar ways, and their ideas mirror those found in the Autumn world. Due to the nature of the Dreaming, concepts that are suppressed or relegated to the realm of fantasy are the most common themes found among Denizens. Though a number of wildly differing ideas exist among the various adhene, the Dreaming is more than large enough for groups with different ruling systems to comfortably occupy their own spaces.

In the fractured, fluid world of the Dreaming, each family of Denizens has a place they call home. These areas reflect the values of each adhene and can vary greatly. Some Denizens still adhere to the trappings and stations of feudal society, while others have adopted more contemporary governing styles. Strange adaptations of communism, democracy, and even theocracy exist in isolated pockets around the expansive landscape of the Dreaming. In other places, Denizens prefer tribal societies, and if even that is too restrictive, anarchy reigns. While some of these more comparable ideas might exist closer together or share some common areas, more disparate ideas will either exist entirely on their own or aggravate conflicting groups that happen to be nearby.

Of course, government is hardly the only system that beings, fae or mortal, use to guide their lives. When it comes to spirituality, religion, or higher powers, Denizens have similarly varied views as they do about society. Some choose monotheistic faiths or introspective concepts, but a majority lean toward pagan and polytheistic beliefs. Many worship vast pantheons comprising the most powerful beings in the Dreaming; among